



where we discussed what went wrong. We had just come off a World Cup and dove straight into the WPL. I need time to get to know people and the management... I am not that person. I, too, needed to understand where they came from. So, we spoke about a lot of important things for a couple of hours. The takeaway of the conversation was what I've said before - This is your team; build it the way you want and set the culture. That was a very big deal for me," she revealed.

Throughout the season, one saw an introverted Smriti being her most expressive self — with pumped-up celebrations, extreme disappointment when something didn't pan out to plan, giving constant pep talks to her bowlers and fielders, and giving her players room to be their authentic selves. That comfort with leadership will come in handy for Harmanpreet Kaur, who relies on Smriti as her deputy in the national side. Smriti, the batter, being kinder to herself and judging a game

So near yet so far: A teary-eyed Delhi Capitals skipper Meg Lanning after her team's loss to Royal Challengers Bangalore in the WPL final.

SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

by its merit and not the weight on her shoulders is an added plus.

For others in the mix, like Saika Ishaque, the going might get tough. Saika got among the wickets a tad late in the season, but her fielding has been a cause for concern since

MOST FIFTIES

Meg Lanning (DC)



4
FIFTIES

FASTEST FIFTY

Kiran Navgire (UPW)



25
BALLS

BEST BOWLING

Ellyse Perry (RCB)



6/15
WICKETS

NO. OF HAT-TRICKS

Deepti Sharma (UPW)



1
HAT-TRICK